

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Azure and Hybrid Infrastructure | Prevent and Protect | Microsoft Defender | CrowdStrike Falcon

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security engineer with over five years of experience strengthening security across hybrid infrastructure and cloud environments, operating within the prevent and protect pillar of enterprise cyber security. I specialise in implementing and managing security controls across Microsoft Azure, Microsoft 365, and on-premises environments, using tools including CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint detection and response (EDR), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), and Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) with Conditional Access and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). At the University of the Arts London (UAL), I have been responsible for securing a hybrid infrastructure environment of approximately 8,000 users, deploying and managing endpoint protection, identity security, vulnerability management, and access governance controls. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, controls-driven approach to improving security posture and reducing organisational risk. I am seeking a fully remote permanent opportunity with a UK organisation where I can contribute immediately to strengthening security controls, hardening the hybrid and Azure estate, and driving measurable improvement in the overall security posture.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Azure and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure security services, Azure Active Directory / Entra ID, Conditional Access policies, identity protection, Azure Policy, cloud security posture management
- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Purview, Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with Kusto Query Language (KQL)
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) - Expert; threat prevention policy management, real-time response, threat intelligence integration
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Entra ID / Azure AD, Conditional Access, MFA enforcement, Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Identity Management, Group Policy
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM - deployment, administration, session recording, and just-in-time access governance
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus - scanning, prioritisation, remediation tracking
- **Security Controls and Hardening:** CIS Controls, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, security baseline implementation across endpoint and cloud layers
- **Hybrid Infrastructure Security:** Endpoint management (Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM, Tanium), network security (Check Point Harmony, IDS/IPS, Mimecast email security), firewall rule management
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development, Logic Apps
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 framework, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned threat hunting and detection engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer - March 2025 - Present
- Microsoft Azure, and Microsoft 365 across approximately 8,000 users, operating primarily within the prevent and protect security function.
- Lead the deployment, configuration, and optimisation of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, implementing security controls and managing the full suite of alerts and investigations.

- Administer Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory, designing and enforcing Conditional Access policies, identity protection baselines, MFA rollouts, and SSO configurations to reduce identity-based risk.
- Manage and optimise the CrowdStrike Falcon EDR platform, configuring prevention policies, managing sensor deployment across the estate, and using the NG-SIEM for advanced threat detection and investigation.
- Operate Microsoft Sentinel SIEM using Kusto Query Language (KQL), writing and tuning custom detection rules aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and managing the full alert lifecycle from triage through to closure.
- Administer BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), governing privileged account access, enforcing least-privilege principles, and ensuring full audit trails for all administrative sessions.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM and Mobile Application Management (MAM) policies, enforcing device compliance, remote wipe capabilities, and application protection across the hybrid device fleet.
- Run vulnerability management programmes using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), producing prioritised remediation reports and working with infrastructure teams to close critical findings.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps to automate containment, enrichment, and notification workflows.
- Lead security incident response activities using the NIST 800-61 framework, managing the full lifecycle of security events including phishing, malware infections, credential compromise, and data loss prevention alerts.
- Manage Tanium for real-time endpoint visibility, patch compliance assessment, and configuration validation across the hybrid estate.
- Administer Mimecast email security, configuring and tuning anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, and impersonation detection policies to protect the organisation from email-borne threats.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity
 Supported the management and improvement of security controls across UAL's hybrid infrastructure, with a focus on endpoint protection, identity security, and vulnerability management within the prevent and protect function. *March 2022 - March 2025*

- Managed Azure Active Directory / Entra ID configurations including user provisioning, Conditional Access policy creation, MFA onboarding, and identity risk reviews.
- Assisted in deploying Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the UAL estate, onboarding endpoints, configuring attack surface reduction rules, and managing alerts through Microsoft 365 Defender.
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon deployment and administration, maintaining sensor coverage, reviewing threat intelligence findings, and actioning host containment where required.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, producing management-level remediation reports and tracking open findings to closure.
- Administered Check Point Harmony firewall, reviewing and managing security policies, documenting rule change requests, and supporting network security improvement projects.
- Contributed to the achievement of Cyber Essentials Plus certification through internal control assessments and systematic remediation of identified gaps.
- Delivered security awareness training and phishing simulation campaigns for over 8,000 users, resulting in a significant reduction in end-user susceptibility over successive campaign cycles.

HGX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure
 Responsible for security, quality, and infrastructure operations supporting a SaaS-based supplier management platform, ensuring the confidentiality, integrity, and availability of company and customer data across hybrid infrastructure. *February 2021 - March 2022*

- Managed endpoint security controls, network access management, and identity governance for the corporate environment.
- Administered MDM solutions for corporate device compliance, enforcing security baselines and application policies across the device fleet.
- Supported internal security audits and contributed to improving alignment with data protection and information security policies.

- Assisted with vulnerability assessments and coordinated patch management activities to address identified risks across infrastructure and application layers.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed and optimised the Microsoft Defender suite (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across approximately 8,000 users at UAL, significantly improving endpoint and identity security controls and reducing dwell time for security incidents.
- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) from evaluation through to production, eliminating unmanaged privileged credentials and enabling comprehensive session recording across all administrative access.
- Led implementation of Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to provide automated, continuous validation of security controls, enabling data-driven prioritisation of security improvements.
- Automated Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) workflows using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, reducing manual alert handling effort and accelerating mean time to contain (MTTC) by over 40%.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification for UAL through systematic internal assessment and remediation of technical control gaps across network, endpoint, cloud, and identity layers.
- Reduced phishing click rates across the UAL user base by over 60% through a structured programme of targeted simulation campaigns and tailored security awareness training.
- Deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM across the enterprise estate, establishing a high-fidelity detection and response capability aligned to MITRE ATT&CK threat intelligence.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 85,000 - 100,000 | Remote (UK)